



Red in the colour, BB the value of blue and GG the value of Green.

Send Outlook XP To The System Tray

Jealous of lucky Outlook 2003 users who get to hide Outlook in the system tray? Fear not. Navigate to `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\10.0\Outlook\Preferences` and in the right-hand pane, select **New > DWORD** and call it "MinToTray". Set the value data to 1, reboot, and Outlook will now sit in the system tray when you minimise it. You won't get anything from right-clicking on the tray icon, though. To reset this to its prior condition, either delete "MinToTray" or set its value to 0.

Show Me The Admin!

When you install Windows XP, it creates a system administrator account (called, by some strange coincidence, Administrator), which will be visible on the login screen only till you



Revealing the hidden Administrator

create a new user account, after which it is hidden from you. To add the Administrator back to the login screen, open the Registry Editor and go to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon\SpecialAccounts\UserList`. Double-click on Administrator if it's there and change the Value Data to 1. If you don't see it, create it by right-clicking in the pane and selecting **New > DWORD**. Name it Administrator and then change the Value data to 1. The next time you start your system, you should see the Administrator in the login screen as well.

Set Programs to Run on Startup Only Once

You've probably encountered RunOnce if you've ever diagnosed your system for startup programs. Programs entered in the RunOnce key will, as the name suggests, run just once before being removed from startup. To add a program to the RunOnce category, navigate to `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnce`. Right-click and select **New > String value**. The name of the value should be the name of the program you want to run, and the Value Data should be the path of that program.

Start Command Prompt From Directories

When you start the Windows Command Prompt, (Start > Run, type "cmd" and press [Enter]), it starts in your user directory. This registry tweak will let you start command prompt in any directory that you choose. Navigate to `HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\Directory`

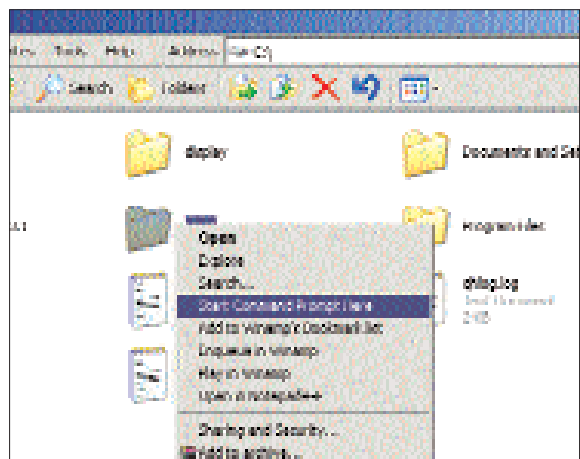
\shell. Right-click on the "shell" key and select **New > Key**. Call it Prompt. On the right pane for the Prompt Key, change the default value data to "Start Command Prompt Here" (without the quotes). Now, under the Prompt Key, create another key called Command. In the default value here, enter "cmd.exe /k cd %1" (again, without the quotes). You should now be able to right-click on any folder and start the command prompt from there.

Increase the USB Polling Interval

Windows constantly checks (polls) USB ports for connected devices. If you don't have any USB devices



The settings for the "Start Command Prompt Here" feature



The menu item in action

connected, you can increase the poll interval to save on resources and power. Laptops especially will be able to enter the power-saving mode faster. Navigate to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\CurrentControlSet\Control\Class\{36FC9E60-C465-11CF-8056-444553540000}\0000`, right-click in the right hand pane and choose **New > DWORD**. Call it "IdleEnable" and set the value data to 1. This will enable USB idling and will increase the polling interval.

Disable the Windows Key

If you don't want to use the special Windows key, you can disable it in the registry. Navigate to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Keyboard Layout`. If it doesn't exist, create a new Binary value (**Right-Click > New > Binary Value**) and call it Scancode Map. Double-click on the value and enter this value data:
00 00 00 00 00 00 00 00 03
00 00 00 00 00 5B E0 00 00
5C E0 00 00 00 00
Restart Windows for this to take effect.

Disable Windows CD Burning

To disable Windows' default CD burning function, use this tweak. Navigate to `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer` (or the same key in `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE` if you want this to apply to all users) and create a new DWORD by right-clicking in the right-hand pane and selecting **New > DWORD**. Call it "NoCDBurning" and set its value data to 1 to disable CD burning. To enable it again, just change the value data back to 0 or delete the DWORD altogether.

Bring Windows to Front à la X-Windows

In X-based operating systems like Unix and GNU/Linux, you have the option of being able to bring windows to the foreground by just hovering the mouse cursor over them. Here's how you can do it for Windows XP too. Navigate to `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop`. You will find a binary value called "UserPreferencesMask". This is different for different people, so this part is a little